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ANSWERS : STIMULUS BASED MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Which of the following factors best explains the alliance between the Spanish and Huejotzingo people?

(A)	Dominant American empires threatened smaller groups with war, slavery, and tribute prior to European conquest	**Correct**: The Aztec and Inca empires operated as hegemonic powers in Meso and South America, dominating large territories and trade networks with their military superiority and allying with the Spanish allowed smaller groups to assist in conquering them.
(B)	The Spanish promised salvation to native people through conversion to Christianity.	**Incorrect**: While the Spanish did attempt to convert Native Americans, this was not a practical consideration by groups such as the Huejotzingo. Most conversion was done by force, not by choice.
(C)	Most Native Americans believed that the Spanish were gods.	**Incorrect**: Some people of lower status in Native American societies did not know what to make of Spanish armor, horses, and firearms. However, indigenous leaders and decision-makers did not believe the Spanish to be gods.
(D)	The Huejotzingo believed they could steal Spanish technology by befriending them.	**Incorrect**: Eventual acquisition of European technology, such as firearms and horses, would play a role in alliances between Native Americans and European, especially in North America. However, leverage in negotiations was almost always in favor of Europeans.

2. According to the excerpt, Spanish treatment of the people of Huejotzingo indicates that colonial life in New Spain was affected by all of the following except:

(A)	the encomienda system.	**Incorrect**: The encomienda system entailed the subjugation of Native American people for the purpose of producing agricultural and mined goods, maize (corn) in this case.
(B)	the castas system.	**Incorrect**: Indigenous people such as the Huejotzingo held a low status in Spanish colonial society and, thus, were burdened with tribute that colonists of Spanish heritage were not.

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(C) the Middle Passage.	**Correct**: The Middle Passage was the slave transporting route of the triangular trade system of the Atlantic Ocean. This excerpt makes no reference, direct or indirect, to African-based chattel slavery in the Spanish colonies, though it would play a large role in most European colonies in the Americas.
(D) the religious conversion of natives.	**Incorrect**: Prior to European colonization, Native Americans practiced varying animistic religions and had not been exposed to Christianity. The Council's reference to the "omnipotent God" indicates their conversion to Christianity.

3. The Spanish demand for maize from the Huejotzingo as tribute best serves as evidence of which of the following developments in the 15th-16th Centuries?

(A) increasing global biodiversity	**Incorrect**: The Columbian Exchange was the spread of new animals, plants (such as maize), and people between the previously unconnected "Old" and "New" worlds. However, this was not a tangible or direct exchange and refers more broadly to the newfound interaction between continents.
(B) growing European populations	**Correct**: Access to new calorically-dense staple crops, such as maize and potatoes, significantly affected European populations. Cultivation of these crops in American colonies through native or slave labor, as well as the planting of them in Europe, became a commercialized venture.
(C) industrial farming methods	**Incorrect**: farming methods remained relatively unchanged until the Agricultural and Industrial Revolutions of the 17th and 18th Centuries in Europe.
(D) European notions of racial superiority	**Incorrect**: While 16th Century interactions between Europeans, Native Americans, and African slaves did cause more racialized views of different societies, the demand for maize, as well as money, from colonial subjects had practical economic motivation.

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4. The territorial disputes such as the one depicted in the map directly contributed to which of the following developments?

(A)	Slave revolts, such as the Stono Rebellion	**Incorrect**: the Stono Rebellion was a 1739 slave uprising in South Carolina.
(B)	Colonial wars, such as The Seven Years' War	**Correct**: The Seven Years' War, known as the French & Indian War in its colonial theater, was the result of competing claims for North American territory between France and England, similar to that of Spain and Portugal's disputed claims which led to the Treaty of Tordesillas.
(C)	Political turmoil, such as the American Revolution	**Incorrect**: Though having roots in the Seven Years' War and eventually involving numerous European powers in the late-18th Century after war broke out, the American Revolution was not directly caused by colonial rivalries but rather by political disputes between colonial governments and the English Parliament.
(D)	Regulatory trade practices, such as the Navigation Acts	**Incorrect**: the Navigation Acts were a series of economic regulations born out of English mercantilist policy. Somewhat influenced by competition with European rivals, these acts were not intended to settle territorial or trade disputes as the Treaty of Tordesillas and Seven Years' War did.

5. Prior to the Treaty of Tordesillas, ownership of territory in the New World was affirmed primarily through what authority?

(A)	Conventions hosted by European governments	**Incorrect**: Intergovernmental conventions had not been held with regard to territorial claims in the New World in the 16th Century.
(B)	The Catholic Church and Pope	**Correct**: In 1493, a papal bull asserted that all land west of an arbitrary line of demarcation was in Spain's possession. This is often referred to as the "Doctrine of Discovery." A year later, the Treaty of Tordesillas moved this line westward, granting Portugal possession of what is present-day Brazil.

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(C) Victors in war laying claim	**Incorrect**: Portugal and Spain did come close to an outbreak of war to settle disputed territorial claims but this was averted by diplomatic efforts.
(D) Previously established international law	**Incorrect**: Portugal's efforts in exploring the coastline of the African continent and into the Indian Ocean prior to other European nations gave them official claim to most undiscovered lands. However, the Pope's granting of land to Spain in 1493 contradicted previous Church doctrine and gave Portugal justification to appeal.

6. Which of the following was not a motivating factor in the Increasing European exploration and colonization in the Americas throughout the 15th and 16th Centuries?

(A) economic and military competition between empires	**Incorrect**: Numerous examples of warfare and mercantilist trade policies motivated European nations to establish colonies in order to grow their reach and wealth.
(B) expansion of Christendom to native populations	**Incorrect**: As Christian nations feeling obligated to save the souls of the perceived "savages" of the New World, the goal of converting Native Americans was significant for the Spanish, Portuguese, and others.
(C) the search for new sources of wealth	**Incorrect**: Gold, cash crops, and the general desire for wealth was the most significant factor in propelling European efforts to colonize the New World.
(D) food shortages in Europe	**Correct**: The population of Europe was relatively stable in the century leading up to European colonization in the New World. Thus, food availability was adequate. Access to new foods as a result of the Columbian Exchange and improved farming methods in the centuries to follow, however, would result in a massive population increase in Europe.

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7. The excerpt would be most useful to historians as a source of information about which of the following?

(A)	the wide range of European perspectives toward Native Americans	**Correct**: As a Spaniard, Las Casas broke with the general conception by Europeans that Native Americans were inferior and that colonists were entitled to use them as they saw fit.
(B)	comparing various approaches to colonization by different European groups	**Incorrect**: There is no mention of Portuguese, French, English, etc. approaches, thus no frame of reference for comparison.
(C)	the role that religion played in the decimation of native populations	**Incorrect**: While Las Casas was a priest and did make scathing religious appeals ("calling themselves Christians"), the observations in the excerpt do not make a connection between the cruelty employed by the Spanish and their religion.
(D)	the harsh realities for Spanish-born colonists in 16th Century New Spain	**Incorrect**: The excerpt solely focuses on the mistreatment of Native Americans by Spaniards. Nothing can be accurately inferred about the lives of Spanish-born colonists.

8. Which of the following most significantly contributed to the drastic decline of Native American populations described in the excerpt?

(A)	the introduction of African slaves who competed with Native Americans for resources	**Incorrect**: Africans who were forcibly brought to the Americas did not actively compete with Native Americans for land and food, as their bondage did not allow such freedom of movement and activity.
(B)	the trade of firearms between European colonists and Native Americans	**Incorrect**: The trade of firearms to Native Americans, especially by the French and English in North America, did foment further and deadlier conflict between rival native groups. However, the impact of firearms on native populations was nowhere near that of new diseases.

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(C)	the establishment of a caste system that deprived native groups of social privileges	**Incorrect**: The Spanish colonial castas system relegated natives and African slaves to the bottom rungs of society. While this certainly made life more difficult for Native Americans, it did not effectively decimate populations like diseases did.
(D)	the transmission of disease that Native Americans had no immunity to	**Correct**: The Columbian Exchange saw many positive effects on European populations, including access to new foods, sources of wealth, and population growth. Conversely, native populations in the Americas were detrimentally affected on the whole, most significantly by diseases such as smallpox and measles. The total population of the Americas prior to European arrival is estimated as high as ~100 million. This number fell to less than 10 million by 1650.

9. Based on the observations of Las Casas, which of the following best describes the Spanish policy toward Native Americans and their land in the 16th Century?

(A)	only indigenous crops, such as tobacco, could be planted and harvested	**Incorrect**: Though the Spanish did attempt to monopolize tobacco cultivation in the early 16th Century, there were no such regulations in place. No reference to crops is made in the excerpt.
(B)	all Native Americans must be killed or removed from their land in order to claim it	**Incorrect**: Despite cruel treatment and "tyrannical warfare" imposed on Native Americans, the Spanish had a vested interest in maintaining populations to some degree for the purposes of labor.
(C)	the Spanish were entitled to free labor and the resources of colonized territory	**Correct**: The encomienda system granted Spanish conquistadors and those that followed with all but supreme authority over the land and people they conquered. This included forcing labor and the right to all resources acquired from the land, including crops and precious metals.

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(D) native populations would not be killed or mistreated if they converted to Christianity	**Incorrect**: Efforts to Christianize Native Americans are thoroughly documented. However, conversion did not necessarily mean improved treatment or status in colonial Spanish society.

10. Which of the following groups was Las Casas trying to influence with this excerpt?

(A) The Roman Catholic Church	**Incorrect**: Roman Catholic Church doctrine implicitly condoned the mistreatment of Native Americans by enacting policies of conversion and forbidding native ceremonies.
(B) the Spanish monarchs	**Correct**: Las Casas ingratiates "kings" by affirming their authority and makes a direct appeal to them as the powers capable of preventing or ending "any wrongs, failings, defects, or evils."
(C) Spanish colonists in New Spain	**Incorrect**: The observations in the excerpt describe the actions of Spanish colonists without any direct appeal or encouragement for change from them, accepting their actions as "custom".
(D) Native American leaders	**Incorrect**: Native American leaders were rarely addressed or involved in decision-making in the Spanish colonies, especially compared to the interactions between the English/French colonists and their Native American counterparts in the 17th and 18th Centuries.

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